

Introduction [First check this]

Label Studio Field:

Pattern Name: Dark Pattern checking

Below four fields are the model detection result:

Status: Indicates whether the model detected the dark pattern:

- "found" – model believes the pattern exists
- "not found" – model believes it does not exist

Evidence:

Model's explanation for why the pattern was found or not.

If the pattern 'found'

- page_url: the URL where the evidence was seen.
- evidence_type: one of "policy_text", "ui_behavior", or "interaction_obstacle".
- raw_snippet: *exact quoted text/HTML* (no paraphrasing)
- observed_ui_text: what the text/behavior implies
- action_taken: what interaction revealed this
- dynamic_outcome: what happened as a result (e.g., "page asked for cookie ID", "form disabled until consent").

If the pattern 'not found'

- page_url: the URL you inspected.
- raw_snippet: the text/section that supports "no pattern"
- observed_ui_text: brief explanation
- action_taken: what model reviewed ("reviewed form submission fields", "scrolled through privacy section").
- dynamic_outcome: describe normal or compliant behavior ("form submitted successfully", "link clearly visible").

Rationale

A short explanation of why the pattern exists or why it is absent.

Matching Confidence: Model's confidence score.

Below six fields are annotators jobs:

Classification Accuracy:

Does the model correctly detect whether this dark pattern is present?

Compare against your ground truth. E.g.,
If ground truth = found, but model = not found → Incorrect.
If ground truth = not found, but model = found → Incorrect.

Explanation Accuracy

Evaluate whether the evidence and reasoning are correct. Please check:

- (a) Does the model give a reasonable explanation for why the pattern exists/does not exist?
- (b) Does the evidence match a mechanism defined in the dark pattern rulebook?

If the model cites unrelated or incorrect mechanisms → mark Incorrect.

Note: If the model outputs 'not found' in status, you can stop after 'classification accuracy'. No need to label the 'explanation accurately'.

Task Completion

Check if the agent is able to complete the task.

Yash, you can ignore evaluating this. Just mark 'complete' as it is a required field.

Problems

Check if the agent processing has any problems. If any issues are found, please select one or more options. Yash, you can ignore evaluating this field.

Review Status

Please select need discussion or no issues.

Comments

Add any helpful short notes, like why the classification is incorrect, why evidence does not match the rulebook

Ground Truth Annotation Process (Annotator Instructions)

1. Using footer to find possible privacy policy links that can lead to CA user exercise right to access.
2. Open the Privacy Policy and identify the sections related to CCPA Right to Access (Right to Know). Evaluate whether the information is: clear, easy to find/follow/understand.
3. If a webform is offered as one of the submission methods for CCPA Right of Access, open the webform to check if the form's instructions are: clear, easy to find/follow/understand.
4. Interact with the webform as a California consumer who exercising Right of Access

5. During all the above steps (policy reading, method discovery, form usage), check whether any dark patterns occur, according to the rulebook categories.

Privacy Mazes

Privacy Mazes

Definition: Require a user to navigate through multiple pages or disconnected sections within the same page to obtain relevant information or control without a comprehensive and exhaustive overview. As a result, the user is prevented from easily discovering relevant information or action possibilities, leaving them unable to make informed decisions regarding their privacy.

Three Matching scenarios:

1. Information about ccpa right of access split across **different disconnect section** on the same page, and **each section have some but incomplete** information,
 - Examples
 - Access instructions are divided across multiple sections, and **no single section explains everything**
 - One phone number appears in one section, another phone number appears in a different section, and **no section lists all phone numbers**
 - One email address appears in one section, another email address appears in a different section, and **no section lists all email addresses**
2. User must **go to different pages** which **each pages have some but incomplete** information about ccpa explanations or submission methods
 - Examples:
 - Phone and email are listed on one page, but mailing instructions appear on another page
 - One phone number appears on one page, another phone number appears on a different page, and **no page lists all phone numbers**
 - One email address appears on one page, another email address appears on a different page, and **no page lists all email addresses**
3. User need **three or more hops before** reaching the pages which contains submission pages, or webform itself (note: home page do not count as 1st page)
 - Examples: four hops before reaching the webform, count as privacy mazes
 - start with the home page → Privacy Policy (1st) → CA Privacy Notice (2nd) → General Privacy Policy (3rd) → Consumer Privacy Rights (4th) → Online Webform
 - Negative Examples: two hops before reaching the webform ⇒ not count
 - start with the home page → Privacy Policy (1st) → CA Privacy Notice (2nd) → Online Webform

Creating Barriers

Creating Barriers

Definition: Subverts the user's expectation that relevant user tasks will be supported by the interface, instead preventing, abstracting, or otherwise complicating a user task to disincentive user action.

Seven Matching Scenarios

1. When users **must** select their **relationship to the company** on the webform. Causing users who are unsure of their role, or who hold multiple roles, cannot proceed smoothly.
 - E.g., one of the field in webform is:
"I am a (an), with options 'Healthcare Professional', 'Study Participant',...."

Note: If the webform has such a field and it is required → Mark "found"

2. When the company provides **only one way** to submit a CCPA request (e.g., webform only, email only), with **no alternatives**.
 - Note: This pattern **DOES NOT** apply when the company explicitly and transparently identifies itself as a **service provider** under the CCPA and clearly explains that it cannot directly respond to individual rights requests
3. When the request requires **disproportionately sensitive or burdensome verification**, e.g.
 - Government-issued ID
 - SSN
 - Biometric or facial verification
 - Physical mailing back for verification

Note: If the privacy policy or webform has such text → Mark "found"

4. When users must provide a **device-level technical ID**, such as:
 - Cookie ID
 - Mobile Advertising ID / MAID / GAID / IDFA

Note: If the privacy policy or webform required to provide such ID → Mark "found"

5. When a form **require** user to complete **Non-Essential Fields**, such as:
 - Supporting file upload (e.g., *"If you have any documentation supporting your request, please attach it"* → However, it is required field for everyone)
 - Cookie ID

- Account number

Note: Essential fields like name, email, phone number, or full mailing address do not count.

6. When users are told they **must download or install another app** (often third-party) to obtain an identifier before submitting a request. Company policy page said
 - E.g., A website says “*Looking for your mobile advertiser ID (\"MAID\")? ... Download any of these apps*”. ⇒ users need to download apps in order to retrieve the MAID for webform submission.
7. When users must **find their own data** (e.g., profile URL or record) before submitting a request, **and** (1) the search process is complex or confusing or (2) the search results are outdated, incorrect, or ambiguous
 - E.g., A website requires users to enter their **profile URL**, When searching for their profile, the site returns **multiple similar or approximate matches**.
⇒ the user **cannot tell which one is theirs** to put on webform

Adding Steps

Adding Steps

Definition: Subverts the user's expectation that a task will take as few steps as technologically needed, instead creating additional points of unnecessary but required user interaction to perform a task.

Two Matching Scenarios:

1. Tell or encourage users to submit **multiple separate requests** for different identifiers, e.g.,
 - Email address
 - IP address
 - Cookie ID
 - Mobile advertising ID (MAID / IDFA / GAID)

Examples:

- (a) A webform includes a single field for **"Mobile Device ID"**, allowing only one ID per submission. Users with multiple devices must submit **multiple separate requests**.
- (b) The privacy policy instructs users with **multiple identifiers** (e.g., old email addresses, nicknames, or past addresses) to **file a separate request for each one**.
- (c) The privacy policy says that each browser has a different cookie, and users must retrieve each cookie ID if you have multiple browsers.
 - (i) Note: this statement's intent is that the user needs to submit one request per cookie since the webform "Cookie ID" field accepts only one cookie ID at a time.

2. When a single Right of Access privacy right is **split into multiple sub-request types**. ⇒ As a result, to receive a complete result, users need to to (1) Submit multiple access requests, **or** (2) Select multiple options (if the field allow multiple choices)

Examples:

- (a) On webform, one field is "Select request type".
And one of the options is *"Request to Access (i.e., specific pieces of personal information)"* and another is *"Request to Know (i.e., categories of personal information)"*
- (b) On webform, one field is "Select your access request type".
And one of the options : *"the category of personal information"* and *"the specific pieces of personal information"*

Visual Prominence

Visual Prominence

Definition: **Place an element** relevant to user goals in visual competition **with a more distracting and prominent element**. As a result, the user may forget about or be distracted from their original goal, even if that goal was their primary intent.

Two Matching Scenarios:

1. **A large, brightly colored** “Create an Account” button visually **dominates the layout**, while the **user’s intended action** (e.g., submitting a request as a guest) **appears as a small, low-contrast link**.

⇒ Result: The prominent element distracts attention away from the user’s primary goal.

2. A persistent **floating UI widget** remains **fixed on the screen** and **overlaps page content or footer links**.

⇒ Result: The visually dominant widget distracts the user and interferes with completing the intended privacy task.

Negative Cases which not count as visual prominence

As they will not distract users if their goal is to understand and exercise right to access

1. Visually prominent call to action in header not count.
2. Content imbalance (one section or link explicitly explains opt-out, but no explicit section or link to explain access) does not count.
3. Marketing form/section or general contact form immediately below the web form

Hidden Information

Hidden Information

Definition: Subverts the user's expectation that relevant information will be made accessible and visible, instead **disguising relevant information or framing it as irrelevant**.

Four Matching Scenarios:

1. **Links are technically present but visually disguised as ordinary text.** The links lack standard visual affordances, such as distinct color contrast, underlining, or bolding, making them indistinguishable from surrounding content during a normal scan.

In other words, users are unable or hard to realize the link was clickable. Because:

- Actionability is hidden
- The link exists, but doesn't look like a link

E.g.,

1. https://www.semcasting.com/privacy_policy

Below screenshot, The email address is hyperlinked in dark blue color, with minimal color contrast and no visual emphasis. ⇒ Make the text blends into surrounding content

and provide you an explanation. To make such a request of us, please contact us at:

Semcasting, Inc.

21 High St Suite 304

North Andover, MA 01845

privacychoice@semcasting.com

Phone Number: 978-684-7580

Toll Free Phone Number (U.S. Only): 888-401-0387

2. The information is **referenced but not linked**.

In other words, the users know the reference text exists, but the text is not hyperlinked so users can't navigate to the referenced part easily.

- E.g. 1. <https://www.windfall.com/privacy>

The policy references a specific '... residents can exercise their rights as provided in our "Your Privacy Choices" form' but it does not provide a clickable link or button to access it

Exercising Your Rights: Residents of U.S. states that provide these rights can exercise their rights as provided in our "Your Privacy Choices" form or by calling us at (800) 946-6710. You are entitled to exercise these rights free from

E.g. 2. <https://www.throttle.io/privacy>

The policy points users to specific sections ('Instructions to submit right to know requests through our Website may be referenced in Sections XVIII-XX') where privacy rights instructions are located, but those section references are not clickable

know in accordance with CCPA requirements. Instructions to submit opt-out requests, delete requests, and/or right to know requests through either our Website or our Toll-Free number may be referenced in Sections XVIII-XX of this Privacy Policy.

3. Privacy rights instructions **not visible in the main content area, but hidden:**

- Behind a "Read more" link
- Within a collapsible section
- Inside a Tooltip or hover-only element

User must perform **extra interaction** to reveal instructions

E.g., <http://localhost:8080/projects/1/data?tab=6&task=4780>

Alternative submission methods are not visible in the main content area. They appear only after expanding a collapsed FAQ item labeled 'Are there other ways to exercise your User Data rights?'

Data Privacy Center

Take control of your user and public data.

User Data Tools

User Data is personal information we collect directly from you when you interact with our site as a visitor or customer including your email address, search history, payment records, etc.

Subject to applicable state data privacy laws, TruthFinder allows all users to exercise the following rights to User Data:

- [Right to Know](#)
- [Right to Opt Out](#)
- [Right to Correct](#)
- [Right to Delete](#)

[View User Data Tools](#)

Public Data Tools

Public Data is publicly available information we compile from various third-party sources and include in Background Reports and other products that our users can access. Most state privacy laws do not apply to Public Data. However, TruthFinder voluntarily provides users with a free tool they can use to suppress their Background Report from appearing when someone searches them by name on our family of people search websites.

TruthFinder gives all users the option to [Suppress Your Background Report](#) using our Suppression Tool.

Judges, law enforcement officers and other protected persons may have additional legal rights under specific laws that can be exercised [here](#).

[View Public Data Tools](#)

Frequently Asked Questions

How does TruthFinder work? [View](#)

What options do I have to control my Public Data? [View](#)

Why do you need me to provide additional information to suppress my Background Report? [View](#)

How do I suppress my Background Report? [View](#)

[Are there other ways to exercise your User Data rights?](#) [View](#)

Will exercising my State Privacy Law User Data deletion request suppress my Public Data? [View](#)

4. A privacy policy page contains a section explicitly dedicated to privacy rights or how to exercise them (e.g., “California Privacy Rights,” “How to Exercise Your Rights”)

The section **appears comprehensive** based on its title or framing.

However:

- (1) The section **omits important information**, such as:
 - The full set of consumer privacy rights, **or**
 - One or more available methods to exercise those rights (e.g., a webform)
- (2) And even the omitted rights or methods **exist elsewhere on the site**. The section provides **no clear cross-reference or link** to where the omitted information can be found

As a result, users are likely to believe that:

- Only the listed rights apply, **or**
- Only the listed submission methods are available

In short: section name signals this section is **comprehensive**. But actually, it **selectively discloses** only narrow rights or methods, while omitting broader rights or more direct controls available elsewhere. (Relevant information is concealed by Fragmented Disclosure / Selective Omission)

Note: this do not count as privacy mazes, as users misled into stopping early, and they are never realized the information

E.g. 1 <https://www.venntel.com/privacy-policy>

“How to Exercise your Rights” section only discloses phone and email, but does not mention webform. After checking, Webform exists elsewhere (in header and footer) and no cross-reference in the section text.

How to Exercise your Rights
In order to exercise any of the rights described above, please contact us by either:
Calling us toll-free at 877-717-9985; or
emailing us at: privacy@venntel.com

E.g., 2 <https://vendelux.com/privacy/>

“California Privacy Rights” section (1) only describes **one narrow right** (sharing for direct marketing) (2) reference user to see ‘contact us’ section to check how to exercise rights. And, in the ‘contact us’ section, the company **only provides a mailing address and email**.

However: Webform for general CCPA rights exists elsewhere in the page, and no cross-reference in the section text.

XII. California Privacy Rights

California residents can request details about any sharing of their personal information by Vendelux with third parties for direct marketing purposes. To submit a request, please contact us by mail or email at the address listed under "Contact Us" below.

XVI. Contact Us

For questions or concerns regarding this Privacy Policy or our privacy practices, please contact us at:

Vendelux, Inc.

Attn: Privacy

115 West 30th Street, Suite 600

New York, NY 10001

Email: privacy@vendelux.com

Negative Cases not count as Hidden Information

- Content imbalance:
 1. There is one section or link explicitly explain opt-out, but no explicit section or link to explain access
 2. No UI for access form but have UI for Opt-out form
- Lead to dead ends:
 1. If the link leads to 404, or redirect to homepage or unrelated page. It is a "dead end" problem. Not hidden information.
- Misleading opt-out form:
- Claim able to exercise Right to Access, but not
- The Privacy Policy page does not have a ccpa description. The CCPA description is under the State Privacy Notice or Privacy Notice page.

Feedforward Ambiguity

Feedforward Ambiguity

Definition: Subverts the user's expectation that their choice will likely result in an action they can predict, instead **providing a discrepancy between information and actions** available to users that results in an outcome that is different from what the user expects.

Five Matching Scenarios:

1. The information presented is **misleading, inaccurate, vague, or incomplete**. Cause the outcome is **different, unclear** than expected

In other words, the UI text or instructions say something. And when the user initiates an action based on what they say, the user finds the resulting page or flow does not match the implied outcome.

E.g. 1: <https://www.transunion.com/consumer-privacy>

- the UI text or instructions says click this link to "[submit as a guest](#)"
- When a user clicks the link, it leads to a page titled 'Create a Free User Profile' with multiple steps focused on account creation, rather than a Right to Access form without creating an account.

E.g. 2: <https://theworknumber.com/cpra>

- the UI text or instructions says click this link for "[CPRA Request Form](#)"
- When a user clicks the form, this form displays with notice stating that California residents should instead use [a different portal](#) to submit a request.

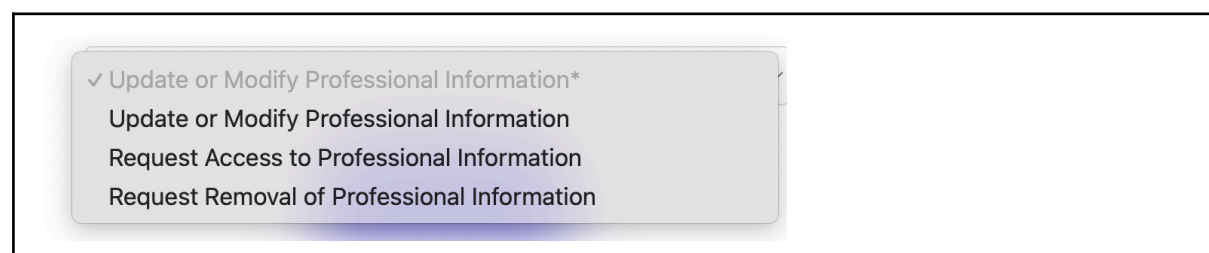
2. Ambiguous labels for rights

In other words, privacy policy or webform use **non-standard or ambiguous terms**, and these terms do **not clearly map to legally defined rights**. And the company has no explanation for what each term means. E.g., for Right to Access, vague terms like:

- "Data Processing"
- "Info Request"
- "Request Access to Professional Information"

No explanation of **what action each option triggers**

E.g.,: "Request Access to Professional Information" is not a standard term. Count as Feedforward ambiguity. <https://vendelux.com/privacy-center/>



However, “get a copy” does not count as non-standard terms. I assume users can understand this map to the right to access requests.

3. Broad links → Restrictive form (scope mismatch)

In other words, when attempting to submit a CCPA request, instruction or link claims to support **all privacy rights**. However, user follows the instruction to a **single form or page** support **only a limited subset of rights** (e.g., opt-out only)

E.g.,: <https://versium.com/california-privacy-policy/>

- The privacy page says “California residents may submit their requests to exercise their CCPA rights by using one of the following methods: Visiting [webform]”
- Open the webform found out it only support Right to Opt Out

4. Correct destination, misleading page label (semantic contradiction)

In other words, the user clicks a link to submit a **general or specific privacy request** (e.g., Right to Access). However, the destination page is titled or framed with a **contradictory privacy label**. (e.g., “Do Not Sell”, “Opt-Out”)

E.g., 1. : <https://www.warmly.ai/p/privacy-policy#your-privacy-rights>

- Company says ‘Your Privacy Right’ form support all privacy rights:

To request to exercise the privacy rights listed above where available under applicable law, please email us at privacy@warmly.ai or complete our webform available here: [Your Privacy Rights](#).

- However, open the webform, found out the form title as “Do Not Sell/Share My Data”

E.g., 2: If the form has contradictory label/title (e.g., Do not sell) but does support the access request, still count as Feedforward ambiguity.

5. User exercise access request. However, its submission also triggers opt-out, and no way to separate these two actions ⇒ As a result, outcome different than expected

E.g., <https://www.venntel.com/right-to-know-request>

The UI indicates that submitting an access request will also opt the user out, with no separate control to submit the access request alone.

Right to Know Request

[Opt Out & Delete Request](#)

[Privacy Policy and Retention Schedule](#)

[Portal License Agreement](#)

Venntel verifies the identity of all requestors prior to disclosing any mobile location data, as required by the California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA). This process prevents the disclosure of data to unauthorized individuals making requests under the CCPA. To submit a "Right to Know" request:

1. Locate the mobile advertising identifier for your device:

iOS Device:

- Install ["The Identifiers"](#) App from the App Store
- Open the app to view your mobile advertising identifier (also called the IDFA on your iOS device)

Android Device:

- Install the ["Device Identifiers"](#) App from the Play Store
- Open the app to view your mobile advertising identifier (also called the AAID on your Android device)

2. Enter the requested information and press 'Submit' to request that we attempt to verify your identity in order to comply with your request. [You will also be opted-out of our use and sale of your mobile location data.](#)

False Positive cases:

1. <http://localhost:8080/projects/1/data?tab=6&task=2753>

The label 'request form' suggests a direct ability to make a Right to Know request, but the form only collects contact details and defers the actual request via the later email

2. <http://localhost:8080/projects/1/data?tab=6&task=182>

Content imbalance, The Access instructions direct users exclusively to phone or email, while the nearby UI exposes an 'Opt-Out Form' without an Access/Right to Know option.

Conflicting Information

Conflicting Information

Definition: Includes two or more sources of information that conflict with each other. As a result, the user is unsure what the consequences of their actions will be and will be more likely to accept default settings that may not be in their best interest.

Note: Conflicting Information does not apply when one source explicitly uses conditional terms (“may,” “can,” “for example”). These terms allow the company to ask for additional information later without contradicting the initial statement. → add to definition

Four Matching Scenarios:

1: Claim support broad instruction but after follow the instruction, found out only limit rights supported

In short,

Source A: Instruction claims the path supports multiple CCPA rights

Source B: Click the path, but the webform supports only opt-out (no access option)

E.g., <http://localhost:8080/projects/1/data?tab=6&task=5459>

1. Privacy policy claim ‘You can exercise any of your rights listed above by visiting our webform here’ <https://www.thinkdatagroup.com>
2. Clicking here lead to webform only support opt-out right (<https://www.thinkdatagroup.com/opt-out-option>)

Case 2: Form Title Contradiction

When a user clicks a link to exercise CCPA Right to Access, they are directed to a page titled/ or labeled as “Opt-Out” or “Do Not Sell”. Although the form may technically include options for accepting other rights, the prominent, contradictory title suggests the page is only for opting out.

Source A: Link indicates access or general privacy request

Source B: Click the link, but Page title says “Opt-Out” / “Do Not Sell”

E.g., 1: <https://ventiveiq.com/privacy-policy/>

- Under the ‘Right to Know’, the company says ‘Residents of the USA may submit such requests via this webform’
- Click the webform, the page header frames the entire form as only for ‘Opt-out’ requests even though the form offers ‘Info Request’ (access) as a request type.

E.g., 2: <https://teamdms.com/state-privacy-notice>

- Under subsection “Making Requests to Know, Access, Delete, or Correct Your Personal Information”, the company says “To exercise your rights to know, access,

delete, or correct your personal information, please fill out our electronic contact form at www.teamdms.com/opt-out.”

- Click the webform, the form is titled as ‘Opt-Out Form’ and do no

3. Submission path conflict

the user encounters conflicting instructions regarding how to submit the request. Specifically, multiple sources each present themselves as an CCPA designated submission method, yet one source indicates that requests can be submitted using a particular submission path or contact point, while another source provides a different or incompatible instruction for the same purpose, or states that certain listed submission paths are not valid.

In short:

Source A: Claims one official CCPA submission method

Source B: Claims a different or mutually exclusive method

Positive case count as Conflicting Information:

- Two different phone numbers are provided for exercise ccpa rights, one in each page:
<https://statara.com/privacy-policy/>
- One page says email can be used for exercise rights, but another page says only webform is a valid method, email can’t be used to submit requests.
<https://thedatagroup.com/privacy/>
- The site invites users to submit requests as a guest but the guest flow itself indicates a later step requires creating an account, presenting conflicting information about whether registration is necessary.

Negative case i do not count as Conflicting Information:

- The policy lists a specific privacy toll-free number while the webform prominently displays a different general customer service number.
 - Because the phone number in webform is explicitly say 'For package-related issues', not for ccpa. So it is not conflicting information.
- The privacy policy list webform and phone as methods to support ccpa right, and it explicitly says ‘Questions unrelated to submitting a data disclosure or deletion request should be sent via email’. So the email is not conflicting information as it is not for ccpa right submission.
- In the privacy policy, under ‘how to exercise rights’ section, the company provides one email address to exercise the rights. And then in the later ‘contact us’ section, the company lists another email address. The two email addresses are not inconsistent information as the email in 'contact us' section is not designed for ccpa exercises.
<https://www.stirista.com/privacy-policy/>

- The policy lists a specific minimal set of required data (first/last name, email, CA address). Such as the policy say “To process your request, We may require that you submit the following information in conjunction with your request: your first name, last name, order number, email address, and a California address. “. While the form UI requires additional data such as Age*
→Do not counts as conflict information, as the policy only say “We may...”
<https://www.spyfly.com/help-center/privacy>

Information Without Context

Information Without Context

Definition: Alter the relevant information or user controls to limit discoverability. As a result, the user is unlikely to find the information or action possibility they are interested in.

Six Matching Scenarios

1. Misdirected form that cannot exercise access

The privacy policy directs users to a single webform to exercise California privacy rights, including the Right to Access. However, **the linked page does not actually allow users to submit an access request**; instead, it supports only other rights (e.g., opt-out rights), is scoped to a different audience (e.g., B2B-only), or is otherwise unsuitable.

In short: The contextual promise of the webform doesn't match the actual webform capabilities. As a result, the miscontextualization prevents user discovery of the correct pathway.

E.g., 1:

- The privacy policy says you can exercise ccpa rights by using the webform.
<https://trueblueanalytics.org/privacy-policy>
- The webform leads to a page labeled for opt-out, and without request type options.
As a result, users are unable to submit access requests from the webform.

How to Exercise Your California Privacy Rights. To exercise your California privacy rights, you may submit your request to us by contacting us at any of the following:

Via Toll-Free Phone: 1-866-1-OPT-OUT (1-866-467-8688) ext. 2245

Via Webform: <https://trueblueanalytics.org/dontsellmydata>

E.g., 2: <https://theworknumber.com/cpra>

- The CPRA page presents only a single "CPRA Request Form" link.
- However, click the CPRA Request Form link, and find out the webform is a not for CA resident to submit CCPA requests

This form is not for residents of California. If you are a resident of California, please refer to the Privacy Preference Center on Equifax.com or call our Customer Care team at 1-866-295-6801 (our regular business hours of 9 A.M. - 9 P.M. EST Monday to Friday, and 9 A.M. to 6 P.M. EST Saturday and Sunday).

https://account.na2.adobesign.com/public/esignWidget?wid=CBFCIBAA3AAABLblqZhD10EAYlfq7muN-yGBFvmlXfwN4LzIZfjK-mCk9PcS7rv_Yw9cCGTr0NAFvua2zrKs*

2: Form Title as Opt-out

In short. The policy promises: “Use this form to exercise access”. But the destination framing of the form says: “This is for opt-out”. Even though access is technically possible, the context signals irrelevance

Note: If the linked page’s URL includes an ‘opt-out’ but the page title is neutral, do NOT count it as this pattern.

E.g., 1. <https://www.usdatacorporation.com/privacy-policy>

- Privacy policy says: “Certain individuals may be entitled to specific rights under applicable law. Such individuals may exercise their rights under applicable law by contacting us through any of these methods: ...By visiting our website: <https://www.usdatacorporation.com/opt-out>”
- Click on the webform, found it is labeled as ‘opt-out’. But this webform, support right to access

3. Vague Request-Type Labeling

The privacy policy directs users to a webform to exercise California privacy rights, including Right to Access/Know. However, the form uses vague or non-standard request-type labels (e.g., “Right to Data Portability”), while other rights may be labeled using clear legal terminology (e.g., “Right to Opt-out,” “Right to Erasure”).

In short: Access request type is present but the label is vague or non-standard

E.g. 1, the webform use “Right to Data Portability” in request type

<https://www.theswarm.com/privacy>

E.g. 2, the webform use “Request to access your professional personal information”

<https://vendelux.com/privacy-center/>

E.g. 3. The webform use “Data processing”, “Info Request”, “Data Portability”

<https://ventiveiq.com/privacy-policy/>

Negative examples:

1. Lead to general form do not count as Information without context

E.g., [stackadapt.com](https://www.stackadapt.com)

CCPA rights request form is a general form without request type.

<https://www.stackadapt.com/legal-document-centre/consumer-rights-web-form>

4. Section Label mismatch

The privacy policy directs users to locate information about CCPA under one section label (e.g., “CCPA privacy notice”), but the relevant information is actually presented under a differently titled section (e.g., “CCPA Addendum”), without any link or explanation indicating that the two refer to the same content.

In short: Information exists but is rendered undiscoverable due to inconsistent section name.

E.g., <https://www.stirista.com/privacy-policy/>

- Page directs users to see 'CCPA PRIVACY NOTICE' section for more information under ccpa.
- Search 'CCPA PRIVACY NOTICE' but found no section name 'CCPA PRIVACY NOTICE'
- The actual section to addendum ccpa should name 'Addendum for California Residents'

5: Omitted Action Guidance (Expected section lacks execution context & actual section is hard to find)

A privacy policy includes a section framed as the comprehensive guide for CCPA rights and how to exercise them (e.g., "California Privacy Rights", "Your Rights and Choices", "Privacy Rights and Controls" or similar). However, this section does **not** include or link to the mechanism for submitting a Right to Access request. The actual submission method (e.g., an online webform, specific email, or phone number for access requests) appears only in a **differently framed** section such as "Contact Us", "General Inquiries", or even an opt-out/marketing choices page, **without any reference or link from the comprehensive rights section**.

In short: users are guided to a "complete" ccpa section. However, the section omits some context, and the real location of the context is hard to find.

Note: this do not count as privacy mazes, as users misled into stopping early, and they are never realized the information

E.g., https://www.weinform.org/privacy_and_policy

- In 'Section 8: iv. Your Rights And Choices':
 - a. The rights section only enumerates rights
 - b. But provides no on-section cue on how to exercise them.
- How to exercise right of access is placed under the bottom section 'section 12. Contact Information'.
- The placement of submission method is out of context because
 - c. 'Your Rights And Choices' signal complete information
 - d. Users are hard to find submission method under "Contact Information" without reference

E.g.,2: <https://www.veeva.com/privacy/>

- The user expands "Residents of California", That section presents CCPA metrics and disclosures only. And It does not surface: (1) instructions (2) links pointers for how to submit a Right of Access request
- The actual submission mechanism exists under "Your Controls"
- There is no cross-reference between the two sections

6. contextual misplacement. (Expected section present partial methods & other methods are not intuitively presented)

A company presents a section that is framed as a comprehensive for understanding how to exercise the CCPA Right to Access (e.g., "How to Exercise your Rights", "California Privacy Rights"). This section provides incomplete or selectively scoped guidance, such as listing only certain submission methods (e.g., mail or email) or only certain steps, but omitting other valid methods or requirements. **The omitted information (e.g., an online webform) appears only in a separate section with a different or unexpected focus (e.g., "Do Not Sell My Personal Information") or on another page, without cross-reference.**

In other words, users are guided to a "complete" ccpa section, but the section only places **partial submission methods**. Instead, the other alternative submission methods are placed in another separate section.

Note: this do not count as privacy mazes, as users misled into stopping early, and they are never realized the information

E.g., 1: <http://localhost:8080/projects/1/data?tab=6&task=5680>
(<https://www.theswarm.com/privacy>)

How to exercise access right is embedded in different topic sections

- 'Exercising Your CCPA Data Protection Rights' section only lists email addresses.
- Alternative access methods, Access request webform link, is shown in the unrelated section named 'Do Not Sell or Share My Personal Information' section.

Negative cases do not count as Information Without Context:

1. Imbalanced visibility of rights is not counted as a dark pattern. Visibility asymmetry between opt-out and other rights is legally okay by CCPA.
2. Privacy policy says "If you wish to exercise your privacy rights, click [here](#)". It is okay to use a general 'click here', no need for more description, already clear context provided:
3. Right to access information buried in the long privacy policy without contextual navigation like Table of Contents or anchor links to help users jump directly to CCPA rights section.
4. in-line link 'contact form' point to 'general contact-us page'
5. "Contact us at the information below" where the contact section immediately follows or is very easy to find.